



▲ **COLT POCKET PISTOL
MODEL 1855**

Date 1855

Origin US

Weight 500g (17½oz)

Barrel 8.9cm (3½in)

Calibre .28in

Elisha Root, the Colt Works Superintendent, designed the 1855 Pocket Pistol. It had a top strap – the first in a Colt pistol – a side-mounted hammer, and a stud trigger. However, it was not very popular and was discontinued in 1870.



▲ **ADAMS SELF-COCKING
REVOLVER MODEL 1851**

Date 1851

Origin UK

Weight 1.27kg (2¾lb)

Barrel 19cm (7½in)

Calibre 40-bore

In this revolver – British gunsmith Robert Adams's first – the entire frame, barrel, and butt were forged out of a single iron billet, making it extremely strong.



▼ **SPANISH CAVALRY PISTOL**

Date 1841

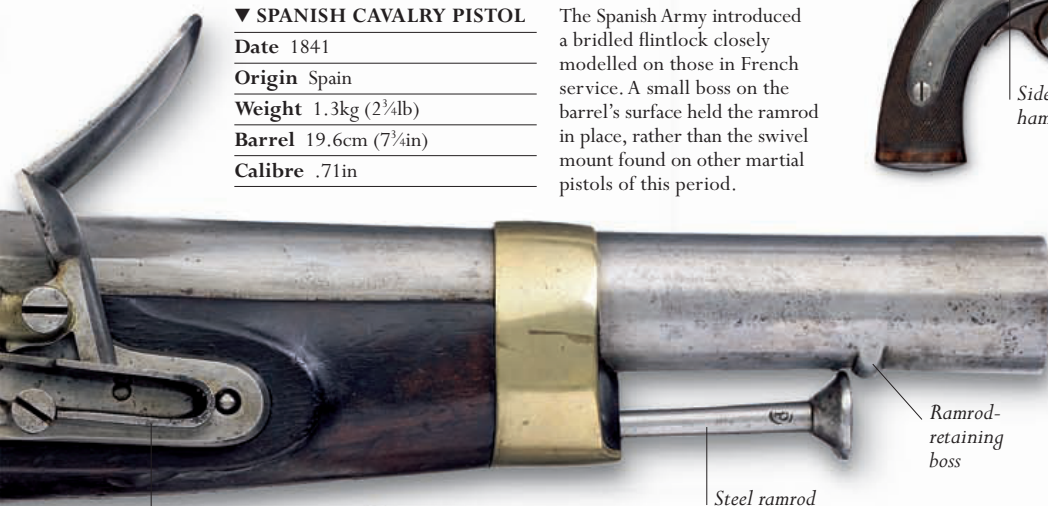
Origin Spain

Weight 1.3kg (2¾lb)

Barrel 19.6cm (7¾in)

Calibre .71in

The Spanish Army introduced a bridled flintlock closely modelled on those in French service. A small boss on the barrel's surface held the ramrod in place, rather than the swivel mount found on other martial pistols of this period.



Feather spring flicks pan open as flint falls

Steel ramrod



▲ **KERR DOUBLE-ACTION
REVOLVER**

Date 1856

Origin UK

Weight 1.2kg (2½lb)

Barrel 14.7cm (5¾in)

Calibre 54-bore

Adams's cousin James Kerr fitted his revolver with a simple box-lock and a side-mounted hammer. The lock was retained by two screws, and could be easily removed. If a component broke, any gunsmith would have been able to repair it.



▲ **DEANE-HARDING
ARMY MODEL**

Date 1858

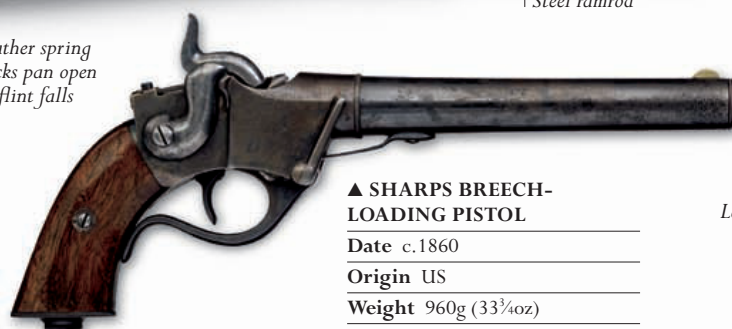
Origin UK

Weight 1.15kg (2½lb)

Barrel 13.5cm (5¼in)

Calibre 40-bore

Deane and Harding's double-action lock was the forerunner of modern actions. In a double-action pistol, pulling the trigger cocks and then releases the action.



▲ **SHARPS BREECH-
LOADING PISTOL**

Date c.1860

Origin US

Weight 960g (33¾oz)

Barrel 12.7cm (5in)

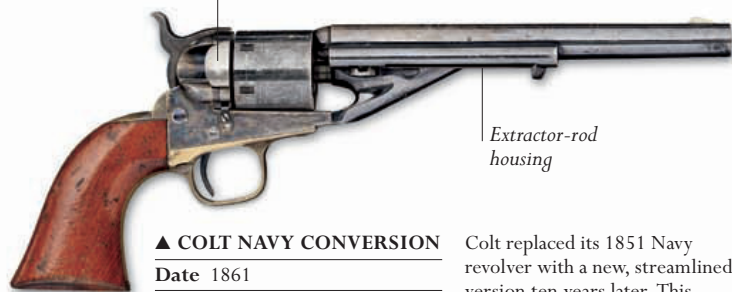
Calibre .34in

American inventor Christian Sharps was famous for his breech-loading rifles and carbines. He also made pistols based on the same principles of his early rifles.



Loading/
ejection gate

Extractor-rod
housing



▲ **COLT NAVY CONVERSION**

Date 1861

Origin US

Weight 1.25kg (2¾lb)

Barrel 19cm (7½in)

Calibre .36in

Colt replaced its 1851 Navy revolver with a new, streamlined version ten years later. This revolver has been converted to accept brass cartridges. Many percussion revolvers were adapted in this way.



▲ **STARR SINGLE-ACTION
ARMY MODEL**

Date 1864

Origin US

Weight 1.35kg (3lb)

Barrel 19.2cm (7½in)

Calibre .44in

American gunmaker Nathan Starr was the pioneer of the break-open pistol, in which the barrel, top strap, and cylinder were hinged at the front of the frame before the trigger guard. The forked top strap passed over the hammer and was retained by a knurled screw.

► **LEMAT PISTOL**

Date 1864

Origin France

Weight 1.64kg (3½lb)

Barrel Lower 12.7cm (5in)

Calibre .3in and 16-bore

In this revolver, designed by Frenchman Jean-Alexandre LeMat, the nine-chambered cylinder revolved not around a pin but a second, unrifled barrel, charged from the muzzle with pellets.

